A SEPARATE COMPANY

The Locker sells. KitLegit checks.

FANS

Sellers and buyers

Use The Locker app, or their club's store

List, buy, get paid

NEW COMPANY

The Locker

The marketplace: one app for fans with KitLegit built in, white-label stores for clubs, payments, shipping and support.

Store, credit, analytics

PARTNERS

Clubs

Their own store, 110% credit spent in their shop, and the data

Every listing is checked

The Locker pays per check

PHYSICAL TAGS

FanNFC

Tamper-proof tags on high-value shirts. Tap to prove it's the one we checked.

Tag links to the certificate

AUTHENTICATION PARTNER

KitLegit

Checks every shirt inside The Locker app and issues the certificate.

Fakes passed on

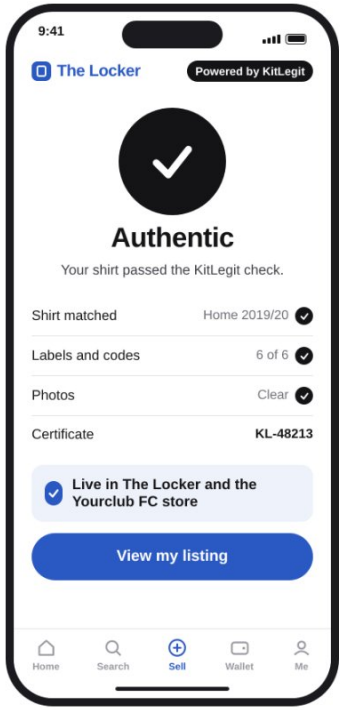
BRAND PROTECTION

Back Four

Acts on fakes for clubs and brands, and opens doors to clubs.

HOW IT WORKS

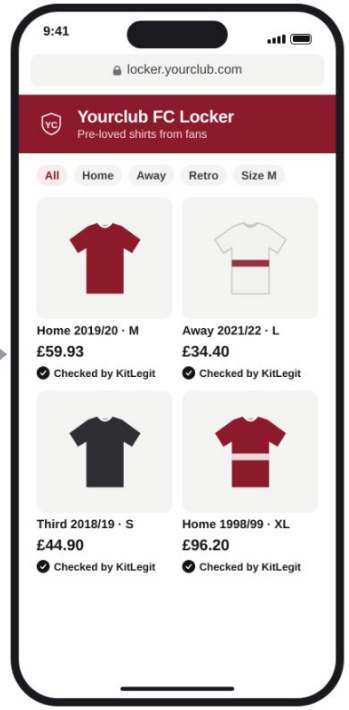
One sale, in three steps



THE SELLER

1. List

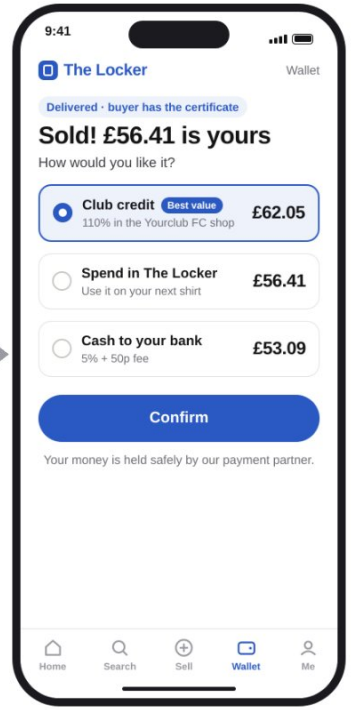
Photos and a price in The Locker app. KitLegit checks it there, so a fake is never listed.



THE BUYER

2. Buy

In the club's store or The Locker app, at one all-in price. We hold the money until it arrives.



THE SELLER

3. Get paid

110% club credit, spend it in The Locker, or cash to their bank.

One app, one store per club. Fans sell in The Locker app and buy there or in their club's store. KitLegit is built in, not a separate step.

IN SHORT

The Locker, in one slide

What it is

A marketplace where football fans buy and sell pre-owned shirts, and every shirt is checked as authentic before it goes on sale.

How it works

Fans list in The Locker app. Shirts sell in the app and in each partner club's own store, and we hold the money until the shirt arrives.

For fans

Buy knowing the shirt is real. Sell for free, and get paid in cash or as 110% credit to spend at their club.

For clubs

Their own resale store, in club colours, on their own website. The credit is spent in their shop, and they see the data.

The partners

KitLegit checks every shirt in the app. FanNFC tags high-value shirts. Back Four acts on fakes for clubs.

Trust and safety

Money held until delivery, strict limits against abuse, and a person decides every dispute.

To decide: price per check · customer data · shared or separate team · legal set-up · suppliers (appendix)

THE MONEY

One month at £30 a shirt

What the business keeps in a month. Support and buyer protection are pots we fill from profit, not costs.

Sales a month	100	500	10,000	100,000
Shirts sold, at £30	£3,000	£15,000	£300,000	£3m
Our fees, after VAT	£394	£1,968	£32,790	£327,900
Payment and payout fees	−£98	−£492	−£9,840	−£98,400
KitLegit checks, at 14p cost	−£42	−£210	−£4,200	−£42,000
Fixed costs: software, insurance, admin	−£100	−£120	−£1,500	−£8,000
Profit a month	**£154**	**£1,146**	**£17,250**	**£179,500**
Profit per sale	£1.54	£2.29	£1.72	£1.79
Of which, into the support and protection pots	£80	£400	£8,000	£80,000

Assumes: half of listings sell, so two listing checks and one dispatch check a sale · half of buyers pay by bank · pots of 50p support and 1% protection a sale · VAT from about 1,900 sales a month

APPENDIX · SUPPLIERS

What we need, and what we'd pick

1. Take payment
Stripe
1.5% + 20p a UK card

2. Hold the money and pay sellers
Stripe Connect
£2 a seller a month + 0.5% + 10p

3. Shipping labels and tracking
ShipStation API
£0 a month

4. Carriers and drop-off
InPost and Evri
From £1.99 a parcel

5. Issue club credit
The club's gift cards
£0

6. Check sellers, report to HMRC
Stripe (built in)
Included

7. Stop fraud
Stripe Radar
Included

8. Answer fans, settle disputes
Help Scout
£0, already ours

9. Chat, email and push
Supabase, Resend, Firebase
£0–15 a month

10. The app, stores and data
Supabase, Cloudflare, PostHog
About £20 a month

11. Company, bank and books
Starling, Xero
£100 when a club signs

12. Terms, rules and insurance
AI drafts, Superscript
About £30–60 a month

Fixed costs at launch: about £500 once, then about £70–110 a month. Everything else is paid per order, so we pay nothing until we sell.

APPENDIX · WORKAROUNDS

Ten ways to stay lean

1. Pay clubs and KitLegit once a month

By bank transfer from our account, with one statement each. No Stripe fees on that money.

2. Choose the payout at the moment of sale

Cash, spend or credit is picked on the sold screen, so few balances get near Stripe's 90 days.

3. Put Pay by Bank first

0.5% + 20p instead of about 2% + 20p for a card, and no chargebacks.

4. Postage paid at checkout

Like Vinted: the buyer pays postage, the seller gets a prepaid QR code. It never touches payouts.

5. Negotiate InPost early

Shops work now with no contract. A locker deal covers the UK and 7 EU countries.

6. Stay under the VAT threshold in year one

Under £90k of fees, registering is optional: about £6k kept. Take advice first.

7. Free tiers first

Help Scout, PostHog, Resend, Firebase, ShipStation and Cloudflare cost nothing at our size.

8. Keep "spend" simple

Launch with cash and club credit. Add spending a balance later at 1.4%, still cheaper than a card.

9. Set up the company when a club signs

£100 online, the same day. Nothing to pay before there's a customer.

10. Let AI do the paperwork

Terms, support answers, scam checks in chats, the HMRC file and first-draft books.

Taking payment: Stripe

Buyers pay one all-in price, in the app or a club store, by card, Apple Pay, Google Pay or straight from their bank.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Stripe **Our pick**	1.5% + 20p UK cards, 2.8% + 20p premium. Pay by Bank 0.5% + 20p	Self-serve, no minimums. The same account holds the money and pays sellers.	Premium cards cost more. £20 for each card dispute.
Braintree PayPal's card service	1.9% + 20p, plus 1% for non-UK cards	Pay as you go, and adds PayPal at checkout.	No UK marketplace payouts, so a second supplier. £20 a dispute.
Adyen Enterprise	11p + card scheme costs + 0.6%	Cheapest at very large volume.	Sales-led, with a minimum monthly invoice.
Paddle Not possible	n/a	Fine for selling software.	Its rules ban physical goods and marketplaces.

Why: self-serve and pay as you go, and one integration covers paying in, holding and paying out.

Workaround: show Pay by Bank first at checkout: 0.5% + 20p instead of about 2% + 20p, and no chargebacks.

Check first: that Stripe accepts pre-owned branded shirts. The KitLegit check on every listing is our answer.

Holding the money: Stripe Connect

Money waits until the buyer has the shirt, then goes to the seller's balance. By law a regulated firm must hold it, not us.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Stripe Connect **Our pick**	£2 a seller a month paid out, plus 0.5% + 10p a payout	Same account as payments. Checks every seller's ID for free.	Balances must be paid out within 90 days. Spending a balance costs 1.4%.
Mangopay Later, if the wallet grows	Custom. Reported platform fee from €249 a month	A true wallet: no time limit, payouts in seconds.	Sales-led contract and a monthly fee before we sell anything.
Adyen for Platforms Enterprise	Custom, with a minimum invoice	Built for very large marketplaces.	Sales-led and far too big for launch.
Our own bank account Not allowed	n/a	Looks simplest.	Holding buyers' money for sellers needs our own FCA licence.

Why: nothing to sign, it is the same Stripe account, and Stripe verifies each seller when they set up payouts.

Workaround: pay clubs and KitLegit monthly by bank transfer, outside Stripe. Sellers choose how to be paid the moment they sell.

Check first: written OK from Stripe that a balance can pay for another seller's shirt (account debits, 1.4%).

Shipping software: ShipStation API

The seller gets a QR code instead of a label, every parcel is tracked, and delivery releases the money.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
ShipStation API Our pick	£0 a month on its carrier rates	Evri, InPost shops, Royal Mail and DPD with no contract, plus tracking.	InPost lockers need our own InPost contract and a £59 a month plan.
Sendcloud Fallback	£0–7 a month. 7p a label on Lite	Has a documented set-up for C2C marketplaces.	The marketplace offer is sales-led. InPost needs a contract.
Packlink PRO	Free, pay per label	Covers InPost, Evri, Royal Mail and DPD.	Weak support reviews (2.2 out of 5). Private sellers unclear.
EasyPost, Shippo US-first	$17–20 a month, plus label fees	Good developer tools.	UK carriers mostly need our own contracts.

Why: free, self-serve and live in days. No carrier contract to launch, and tracking alerts release the seller's money.

Workaround: buy every label on our account and add postage to the buyer's price. One monthly bill, and no postage in payouts.

Check first: that its terms allow labels for private sellers, and Royal Mail's limit of 20 parcels a week.

Carriers: InPost and Evri from day one

A shirt is a small, light parcel that fits a locker. Fans want cheap drop-off near home, with no printer.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
InPost **Our pick**	£1.99 locker or shop to locker or shop	Shops with QR codes now, via ShipStation. 82,000 points in 8 countries.	Lockers need our own InPost deal. Negotiate it now.
Evri **Our pick too**	£2.29–3.04 a small parcel	11,000+ shops and lockers, QR drop-off, no contract via ShipStation.	Weaker reputation. No loss cover on ShipStation's account.
Royal Mail Premium option	£3.75 Tracked 48, online	22,000+ drop-off points, the most trusted, £75 cover.	The dearest of the four. Post Office queues.
DPD	About £2.99 shop to shop	Reliable, 12,000 pickup points.	Sellers need a printed label.

Why: both work on day one with no contract, and they are what Vinted and eBay offer. InPost scales into Europe with us.

Workaround: negotiate an InPost marketplace deal for lockers. It covers the UK and 7 EU countries, so one deal grows with us.

Check first: InPost's rates through ShipStation, and whether it will sign a start-up with no minimum volume.

Club credit: the club's own gift cards

When a seller picks 110% credit, the club's own shop issues it. We pay the club monthly for the credit issued.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Shopify gift cards **Our pick**	Free, on every Shopify plan	We create the gift card by API the moment the seller chooses.	Only for clubs whose shop runs on Shopify.
Codes from the club **Our pick for other shops**	Free	Works on any shop: the club gives us a batch of codes.	Someone tops the batch up before it runs out.
Our own credit shop For custom-built shops	Free. We build it once	The club's products sit in its Locker store. Fans spend credit there.	The club sends a product list, and staff post the orders.
Shops run by Fanatics Big clubs	By agreement	Runs Chelsea, Leeds, Sunderland, Sheffield Utd.	No self-serve option: a deal with the operator for each.

Why: no new supplier. Credit lives in the club's own shop, so fans spend it where they already buy kit.

Workaround: we buy the credit and settle once a month from our bank, with one statement. No Stripe fees on club money.

Check first: the VAT treatment of the credit, and that credit for one club's shop isn't e-money. One accountant call.

Seller checks and HMRC: Stripe, built in

The law says we must know our sellers, and report anyone with 30+ sales or over €2,000 a year to HMRC by 31 January.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Stripe Connect sign-up **Our pick**	Included in Connect	Checks every seller before they're paid. Nothing extra to build.	Doesn't stop a fake account from listing before payout.
Stripe tax reporting **Our pick for HMRC**	In preview: ask Stripe	Makes the HMRC file and each seller's statement.	Still a preview, and Stripe accepts no liability.
Stripe Identity Only when risky	£1.25 a check, first 50 free	ID plus selfie, only for flagged sellers.	One more step for the seller.
Veriff	$0.80 a check, $49 a month minimum	Cheapest per check.	A monthly minimum and another supplier.

Why: Stripe already checks every seller who gets paid. We add date of birth and NI number at sign-up, and the HMRC report uses the same data.

Workaround: ask for ID only when it matters: high-value listings or flagged accounts. AI can write the yearly HMRC file.

Check first: access to Stripe's tax-reporting preview. The first HMRC report is due 31 January 2027.

Fraud: Stripe Radar, plus our own rules

Every shirt is checked, so fakes are rare. The risks are stolen cards, “never arrived” claims, scams and hacked accounts.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Stripe Radar **Our pick**	Included. Standard from £15 a month	Blocks stolen cards with nothing to build.	£20 per card dispute. Covers payments, not scam messages.
Signifyd Enterprise	A % of each order, unpublished	Pays back fraud chargebacks it approved.	Built for big retailers.
SEON	$699 a month	Device and email signals against hacked accounts.	About £6k a year: too much for now.
Sift Enterprise	Quote. About $10k a year	Strong against account takeover.	Sales-led and priced for large firms.

Why: Radar and 3D Secure cover card fraud. Holding the money until tracked delivery covers “never arrived” and seller scams.

Workaround: Pay by Bank has no chargebacks. Supabase login protection is free. AI flags scam messages in chats.

Check first: which Radar price applies to platforms after Stripe’s changes on 22 January 2027.

Support: Help Scout, which we already use

Most questions are “where’s my shirt?” and “when do I get paid?”. AI answers those. People decide disputes.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Help Scout **Our pick**	Free: 5 users, 100 contacts a month. AI answers $0.75 each	Already in use. AI answers from our help docs.	Free plan stops at 100 contacts a month, then $25 a user.
Our own AI helper In the app, with AI	Pennies a chat in AI costs	Answers from live order data: tracking, payout status.	We build it. Hands anything else to Help Scout.
Freshdesk	Free for 6 months, then $19 an agent	Cheap paid seats.	The free plan runs out, and switching costs time.
Zendesk Enterprise	$55 an agent a month	Mature dispute workflows.	Costs grow per agent and per AI answer.

Why: free, already set up, and the team knows it. Dispute evidence (chat, photos, tracking) is in our own back end anyway.

Workaround: answer the top questions in the app before anyone writes in: live tracking, payout status and an AI helper.

Check first: how fast we pass 100 contacts a month. Help Scout’s paid plan is the next step.

Messages and alerts: three services, mostly free

Buyers and sellers chat about an order, and the app sends an email and a push alert at each step.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Supabase Realtime **Our pick for chat**	Included in Supabase Pro ($25 a month)	Chats sit with the order, ready as dispute evidence.	We build unread counts and moderation.
Resend **Our pick for email**	Free to 3,000 a month, then $20 for 50,000	Plugs straight into Supabase.	The free plan stops at 100 emails a day.
Firebase Messaging **Our pick for push**	Free	Google's push service, with no user cap.	Bare service: we build the targeting.
Stream Chat Ready-made chat	Free to 1,000 users, then $399 a month	Polished chat screens out of the box.	A big jump after the free tier.

Why: all three plug into the stack we already run. Extra cost at launch is about £0 to £15 a month.

Workaround: AI checks chats for phone numbers, bank details and "pay me outside the app", and flags them.

Check first: that we set up Resend before launch. Supabase's built-in email is for testing only.

The tech: KitLegit's, reused, plus two services

The Locker app is KitLegit's code, repurposed. Club stores are one site that changes with the club's web address.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Supabase Our pick	Pro $25 a month	Already in use: database, logins, files, chat and search.	Shared with KitLegit or separate? That decides data ownership.
Cloudflare Our pick	Free hosting. 100 club domains free, then $0.10 each	Built for many club web addresses, with security included.	Each club adds one record to its domain settings.
PostHog Our pick	Free to 1 million events a month	Analytics, screen replays and switches per club.	Cookie consent on the club stores.
Azure Already ours, for AI	Pay as you go	Already runs KitLegit's AI checks.	Its simple hosting allows only 6 club domains per site.

Why: the same stack, plus Cloudflare for club web addresses and free analytics. Azure stays for the AI.

Workaround: no search or chat supplier. Postgres search and Supabase chat do the job at launch, for free.

Check first: whether The Locker shares KitLegit's Supabase project or gets its own.

Company set-up: when the first club signs

Nothing until a club signs. Then a limited company, a bank for our own money (never sellers') and simple books.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
Companies House **Our pick**	£100, online, same day. £50 a year	Set up the day the first club signs.	Stripe, Apple and the bank need it: allow 2–3 weeks to launch.
Starling **Our pick for the bank**	£0 a month	A full UK business account, free.	Confirm it is happy with a marketplace business.
Xero **Our pick for the books**	From £18 a month, 90% off for 6 months	Reads Stripe automatically. Most accountants use it.	The entry plan has limits; move up when VAT starts.
Apple and Google App stores	Apple $99 a year. Google $25 once	Shirt sales pay by Stripe: no Apple or Google cut.	Apple needs a D-U-N-S company number: apply on day one.

Why: the cheapest set-up that works: a free bank, books that read Stripe, and an accountant only for year end.

Workaround: stay under the £90k VAT threshold in year one: about £6k kept on the plan's numbers.

Check first: the VAT position with an accountant: VAT is on our fees only, never on the shirts.

Legal: AI drafts, plus a few must-dos

No law firm needed to launch. We need clear terms, a few registrations and basic insurance.

Option	Cost	Good for us	Watch out
AI-drafted terms **Our pick**	£0	Buyer and seller terms, privacy, refunds, reviews and safety.	Not legal advice. An optional one-off review.
Sprintlaw review Optional	Fixed fee, usually £100–1,500	A lawyer checks the AI drafts once.	Get the fixed quote in writing first.
Superscript **Our pick for insurance**	About £30–60 a month, our estimate	Monthly, cancel any time. Liability, indemnity and cyber.	Must cover marketplace and authentication claims.
Registrations Must do	ICO £52 a year. Trade mark £265	ICO is the law. The trade mark protects the name.	Search “The Locker” for clashes first.

Why: AI drafts from what we already know. The money goes on insurance, which protects us from one bad claim.

Workaround: start from KitLegit’s own terms and policies, and use Ofcom’s free online safety toolkit.

Check first: the Online Safety Act risk assessments, due within 3 months of launch.